## SPEAKER BIOS

### 1 Winning presentation from 2026 PRECISE Summer Student Symposium

*Rubesan Christian Joy Rajakumar*

***Title**: Graduate student at Institute of Medical Sciences*

BIOS:

Rubesan is currently a graduate student researcher in the Institute of Medical Sciences. During the past 2 years of his undergraduate degree, he researched human proteins incorporated onto the surface of HIV under the supervision of Dr. Christina Guzzo. This past summer, he transitioned to influenza research as a PRECISE summer student from where he's collected and curated the data he'll be presenting today.

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### 2 Keynote presentation: NAVIS study

*Dr. Roger Paredes*

***Title**: Head of Infectious Diseases Dept at* Hospital Germans Trias i Pujol and Principal Investigator of the Microbial Genomics Group at the IrsiCaixa AIDS Research Institute

BIOS:

Roger Paredes is Head of the Infectious Diseases Department at the Hospital Germans Trias i Pujol and Principal Investigator of the Microbial Genomics Group at the IrsiCaixa AIDS Research Institute, Badalona, Catalonia, Spain.

Paredes serves as the Spanish National Coordinator of seminal NIH/NIAID-funded randomized clinical trials, which have defined the current standard of care for in hospitalized SARS-CoV-2 patients as well as in outpatients. Additionally, Paredes coordinates the 10 million-euro H2020 EU grant MISTRAL and is co-PI in 3 grants from the Canadian Institutes of Health Research aimed at disentangling the role of the human microbiome on HIV pathogenesis, transmission and associated cancers. He is also a member of the WHO HIV Drug Resistance Strategy (ResNet) Steering Committee, the WHO HIV treatment guidelines group, and the WHO Clinical Network on COVID- 19. Paredes leads an international Research initiative through the WHO called NAVIS (Natural History of Andes Virus Infection Study) to advance understanding of Andes hantavirus, following the outbreak detected this year linked to the MV Hondius cruise ship

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### 3 Panel discussion: Lessons learned from the Hantavirus outbreak: Integration between Public Health and Research

MODERATOR: **Dr. Allison McGeer**

BIOS:

Dr. McGeer is an infectious disease physician at Sinai Health and a Professor in the Department of Laboratory Medicine and Pathobiology and at the Dalla Lana School of Public Health at the University of Toronto. Her research interests are in infection prevention in healthcare and in the community, antimicrobial resistance, adult vaccination and pandemic preparedness. She has received international recognition for her leadership in emerging infectious disease response.

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PANEL MEMBER 1: Dr. Roger Paredes

Title: *Head of Infectious Diseases Dept at* Hospital Germans Trias i Pujol

BIOS: See above

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PANEL MEMBER 2: Dr. Jessica Hopkins

Title: Vice President and Chief, Communicable Disease Control, Public Health Ontario

BIOS:

Dr. Jessica Hopkins oversees the scientific and operational activities of the Communicable Disease Control portfolio, which consists of: Medical and System Support, Operations and Response, Indigenous Strategy and Capacity Building. The portfolio's work strengthens communicable disease management across the health system through outbreak response; communicable disease surveillance and control; infection prevention and control; developing an Indigenous Strategy in partnership First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and organizations, and building capacity through events and online programming.

Jessica has more than 15 years experience in public health having previously worked as the Medical Officer of Health for Peel Region, and as Associate Medical Officer of Health in Hamilton and Niagara Region. She works as a family doctor and is an Associate Professor (part-time) with the Department of Health Research Methods, Epidemiology, and Impact, McMaster University and Assistant Professor with the Dalla Lana School of Public Health, University of Toronto.

Jessica obtained her Doctor of Medicine from the University of Western Ontario and her Master of Health Science from the University of Toronto in the field of Community Health and Epidemiology. She completed residencies in Family Medicine and Public Health and Preventive Medicine at McMaster University.

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PANEL MEMBER 3: Dr. Samir Patel

Title: Vice President and Chief of Microbiology and Laboratory Services at Public Health Ontario Laboratory

BIOS:

Dr. Samir Patel is a Vice President and Chief of Microbiology and Laboratory Services at Public Health Ontario Laboratory within Public Health Ontario. In addition to his executive role, Dr. Patel provides clinical oversight in various areas, including bacterial vector borne diseases, antibiotic susceptibility testing, and hospital associated infections. Dr. Patel is also an associate professor in the Department of Laboratory Medicine and Pathobiology at the University of Toronto

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PANEL MEMBER 4: Dr. Daniel Warshafsky

Title: Associate Chief Medical Officer of Health for the Office of the Chief Medical Officer of Health in Ontario.

BIOS:

Dr. Daniel Warshafsky is a Public Health and Sports Medicine physician. He currently works as the Associate Chief Medical Officer of Health for the Office of the Chief Medical Officer of Health in Ontario, where his portfolio includes immunization, therapeutics, primary care, and health care system partnerships. He continues to practice clinically at the University Health Network Toronto Rehab Institute where he specializes in concussion management.

Dr. Warshafsky holds a Doctor of Medicine degree from Western University and a Master's degree in public health from Columbia University. He is a Fellow of the Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Canada in Public Health and Preventive Medicine. He is also licensed in Family Medicine with a Diploma in Sport and Exercise Medicine. He is an Assistant Professor at the Queen's University Department of Family and Community Medicine, and Adjunct Lecturer at the University of Toronto's Dalla Lana School of Public Health, and an Adjunct Professor at the University of Ottawa, School of Epidemiology and Public Health.

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PANEL MEMBER 5: Dr. Natalie Knox

Title: Acting Chief Science Officer, Public Health Agency Of Canada

BIOS:

In her role, Dr Knox provides strategic leadership to advance scientific excellence and strengthen science-policy integration for the Public Health Agency of Canada (PHAC). During public health emergencies, she serves as the incident management lead for science, research and ethics at PHAC.

Her expertise spans genomic epidemiology, microbial genomics, metagenomics, and public health surveillance. She served as Director of the Bacterial Pathogens, Antimicrobial Resistance, and Wastewater Section at PHAC's National

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Microbiology Laboratory (NML), where she led Canada's federal wastewater monitoring program. Previously, as Head of the Computational Biology Unit, she oversaw large-scale microbial genomics initiatives, helped build national capacity in genomic epidemiology, and led the development of key public health genomics platforms, including the Canadian SARS-CoV-2 genomic database and the National MPOX genomics database.

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PANEL MEMBER 6: Patrycja Thompson

Title: Director of Strategy & Operations, Canadian Hub for Health Intelligence & Innovation in Infectious Diseases (HI3), Temerty Faculty of Medicine, University of Toronto

BIOS:

Patrycja holds an MSc in Pathobiology from the Ontario Veterinary College, University of Guelph, and a PhD in Immunology from the University of Toronto, with postdoctoral training at Fox Chase Cancer Center. Her career spans vaccine development at VIDO, research funding management at Sunnybrook, and technology commercialization at CCRM, where she led diligence and venture creation for regenerative medicine discoveries. She later drove cross-sectoral strategic partnerships and consortia building for University of Toronto's Strategic Initiatives.

As Director of Strategy & Operations at HI3, Patrycja builds national research and business strategies and operations that connect academic, industry, non-profit, and government partners to strengthen Canada's life sciences and biomanufacturing ecosystem—advancing dual-use technologies, biodefense, and health security.

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PANEL MEMBER 7: Dr. Graham Tipples

Title: Medical-Scientific Director of the Provincial Laboratory, Public Health in Alberta

BIOS:

Dr. Graham Tipples is the Medical-Scientific Director of the Provincial Laboratory for Public Health in Alberta and has been in this role since 2012. His responsibilities have included leading the laboratory response to COVID-19 in Alberta including diagnostics, surveillance and applied research. Prior to his role leading the public health lab in Alberta, he was with the National Microbiology Laboratory, Public Health Agency of Canada, for 16 years and was involved in numerous responses to emerging diseases including SARS and pandemic H1N1. Dr. Tipples has a PhD in medical microbiology and is certified as a clinical

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microbiologist through both the Canadian College of Microbiologists (FCCM) and the American Board of Medical Microbiology ((D)ABMM).